

GRADE 7 · READING INFORMATIONAL TEXT · RI.7.6

Author's Point of View and Purpose

Determine each author's point of view and purpose in two passages on school uniforms, and analyze how each author distinguishes their position from the opposing view.

Lesson Map · Passage · Guided · Partner · Independent Practice · Small Group · Answer Key

What You Will Learn Today

Learning Goals

Understand RI.7.6: Determine each author's point of view and purpose in two passages on S...

Read an original passage closely

Support every answer with text evidence

Work through guided, partner, and independent practice

How the Lesson Runs

Warm-up and passage

Guided practice together

Partner discussion

Independent + small-group work

Exit ticket and answer key

Unpacking the Standard

An author's point of view is their opinion or stance on a topic. Purpose is why they wrote the text (to persuade, inform, entertain). Authors distinguish their position by acknowledging the opposing view and then explaining why their own view is stronger.

Modeled Example

An author writes: "Some argue uniforms limit expression. But uniforms save families money and reduce morning conflict." What technique is used?

Acknowledging the opposing view ("some argue...") before countering it with the author's own reasons, a common way authors distinguish their position.

What is the likely purpose of a text that uses phrases like "we must" and "it is essential that"?

To persuade — this language pushes readers toward a specific action or belief, rather than simply informing them.

Passage A: A Uniform Solution

1. Walk into any middle school cafeteria without a uniform policy, and you will see the problem before anyone explains it to you: clothing has become a sorting mechanism, separating students by what their families can afford.
2. Critics of uniform policies argue that uniforms suppress individual expression, and it is true that students lose some choice over daily clothing. But this argument overlooks what students gain: a measurable reduction in appearance-based social pressure. Schools that adopted uniform policies report fewer incidents of clothing-related teasing and bullying, according to several district surveys conducted after policy changes.
3. Uniforms also address a quieter, practical problem: cost. A family purchasing five uniform outfits spends significantly less over a school year than a family trying to keep a middle schooler current with rotating trends. For families already stretched thin, this is not a minor benefit.
4. Some worry uniforms erase individuality entirely. But individuality was never really about clothing brands — it shows up in how students speak, create, lead, and think. A uniform policy removes one narrow, expensive avenue for self-expression while leaving every meaningful one intact.

Passage A: A Uniform Solution, continued

5. Schools exist to prepare students for a world with expectations and structures. A uniform policy, thoughtfully applied, teaches an early, low-stakes lesson in operating within a shared system — while quietly leveling a field that, without it, was never level to begin with.

Passage B: Let Students Choose

1. Proponents of uniform policies point to reduced bullying and lower costs. These benefits sound appealing, but they treat a symptom while ignoring the actual problem, and they come at a real cost to something schools should be protecting, not restricting: student voice.
2. Clothing is one of the first spaces where young people practice self-definition. A student who dresses in a way that reflects their culture, their interests, or simply their mood that day is exercising a small, daily act of agency. Removing that choice does not resolve social pressure around appearance; it just redirects it toward hairstyles, shoes, and backpacks, the details uniform policies cannot regulate.
3. The cost argument deserves scrutiny, too. Uniform policies often require families to buy specific branded items from a limited number of approved vendors, sometimes at prices comparable to, or higher than, ordinary clothing. The savings claimed by uniform advocates are not guaranteed, and in some districts, families have reported the opposite.
4. If the goal is genuinely reducing appearance-based bullying, schools have more direct tools: explicit anti-bullying policies, restorative discipline practices, and a school culture that actively values difference rather than erasing it through matching outfits.

Passage B: Let Students Choose, continued

5. Structure and expectations matter in schools, but so does teaching students to navigate a world of real choices, not a simplified one where a single daily decision has been made for them. A uniform is not a lesson in responsibility; it is the absence of an opportunity to practice it.

Warm-up · Before You Read

1. What is the author of Passage A's point of view on school uniforms?

2. What is the author of Passage B's point of view on school uniforms?

Guided Practice

3. What is the likely purpose of both passages?

4. How does Passage A's author acknowledge the opposing view, according to paragraph 2?

Guided Practice

5. How does Passage A distinguish its position after acknowledging that opposing view?

6. How does Passage B's author acknowledge the opposing view, according to paragraph 1?

Partner Discussion

7. How does Passage B distinguish its position after acknowledging that opposing view?

8. What specific evidence does Passage A use to support its cost argument?

Partner Discussion

9. How does Passage B challenge that same cost argument?

Independent Practice

10. What alternative solution does Passage B propose instead of uniforms, according to paragraph 4?

11. How do both passages use the word "individuality" or "individual expression" differently to support opposite conclusions?

Independent Practice

12. What tone does Passage A use in its final paragraph, and how does it support the author's purpose?

13. What tone does Passage B use in its final paragraph, and how does it support the author's purpose?

Independent Practice

14. Both authors mention "cost." How does each author use this same topic to support opposite positions?

15. Which passage's argument about bullying do you find more directly supported by evidence within the text? Explain.

Small-Group Work

16. How does each author's choice of what to discuss first (paragraph 1) reveal their distinct position?

17. Explain how Passage B's author distinguishes their position from Passage A's specific claim about reduced bullying.

Small-Group Work

18. If you combined the strongest point from each passage, what compromise position might emerge?

19. Why is it useful to read two opposing viewpoints on the same topic rather than just one?

Exit Ticket

20. Identify each author's point of view, purpose, and one specific technique they use to distinguish their position from the opposing side.

Answer Key (1 of 4)

1. In favor of uniform policies — the author argues they reduce social pressure and cost.
2. Opposed to uniform policies — the author argues they restrict student voice and self-expression.
3. To persuade readers to support or oppose school uniform policies.
4. The author admits "students lose some choice over daily clothing" and that critics argue uniforms "suppress individual expression" before countering with the benefit of reduced social pressure.
5. It argues that individuality "shows up in how students speak, create, lead, and think," not through clothing, so removing uniform choice does not erase meaningful self-expression.

Answer Key (2 of 4)

6. The author admits the benefits (reduced bullying, lower costs) "sound appealing" before arguing they only treat a symptom rather than the real problem.

7. It argues that removing clothing choice does not resolve social pressure, but instead "redirects it toward hairstyles, shoes, and backpacks," and proposes more direct solutions like anti-bullying policies.

8. It states that families purchasing uniform outfits "spend significantly less over a school year" than families keeping up with rotating clothing trends.

9. Paragraph 3 argues that uniform policies often require buying specific branded items from limited vendors, sometimes at prices comparable to or higher than ordinary clothing, and that savings are "not guaranteed."

10. Explicit anti-bullying policies, restorative discipline practices, and a school culture that values difference.

Answer Key (3 of 4)

11. Passage A argues individuality is unaffected by uniforms since it shows up in speech and ideas, while Passage B argues clothing itself is a meaningful, daily act of self-expression that uniforms take away.

12. A confident, reasoning tone ("thoughtfully applied," "quietly leveling a field"), reinforcing the persuasive purpose by presenting uniforms as a fair, sensible solution.

13. A firm, values-driven tone ("the absence of an opportunity to practice it"), reinforcing the persuasive purpose by framing uniforms as a missed lesson in responsibility rather than a source of it.

14. Passage A uses cost as evidence in favor of uniforms (families save money); Passage B uses cost as evidence against uniforms (families may not actually save, given branded-vendor pricing).

15. Answers vary; Passage A cites "district surveys" showing fewer incidents, which is a specific evidence type, while Passage B argues bullying is "redirected" without citing a specific study — a reasonable answer could favor either, if the reasoning is supported.

Answer Key (4 of 4)

16. Passage A opens by describing clothing as an unfair economic "sorting mechanism," framing the issue around fairness; Passage B opens by directly challenging the opposing side's "appealing" benefits, framing the issue around scrutinizing claims.

17. Passage B does not deny that uniform policies might correlate with less reported clothing-based bullying, but argues the underlying social pressure is only "redirected" elsewhere, not resolved, distinguishing a deeper critique from Passage A's surface-level claim.

18. Answers vary; a reasonable synthesis might combine Passage A's cost/fairness goal with Passage B's call for direct anti-bullying policies, suggesting schools could pursue both affordability measures and explicit anti-bullying programs rather than relying on uniforms alone.

19. It helps readers understand the full range of evidence and reasoning on an issue, recognize how authors use the same facts (like cost) to reach different conclusions, and form a more informed opinion.

20. Answers vary; require a correctly identified point of view and purpose for at least one passage, plus one specific technique (such as acknowledging and countering the opposing view) with textual evidence.

Exit Ticket

Answer on a sticky note

Answer the exit-ticket question from today's lesson.

Cite at least one piece of evidence from the passage.

Remember

Name your claim or answer

Quote or cite the evidence

Explain how it supports your answer